FAQ

The questions everyone asks before trusting an exposure checker.

Exposure-Check-OSINT v1.6.0 · Apache-2.0 · self-hosted · keyless · no AI · github.com/RanaKhan77/Exposure-Check-OSINT

Does my password ever leave my machine?

No. Your browser hashes it with SHA-1 locally and sends only the first 5 hex characters of that hash. The server fetches the hash-suffix range for that prefix from HIBP's free Pwned Passwords API and returns it; your browser does the final match locally. The full hash — and the password itself — never reach the server. This is the same k-anonymity design used by 1Password, Bitwarden and haveibeenpwned.com's password check.

Can I check someone else's email/phone/username?

The tool is for checking identifiers you are authorized to assess — yours, or your organization's with permission. The README and this FAQ say it plainly: using exposure data to harass, dox or attack people is abuse, and the tool gives you aggregate counts and public-record signals, not ammunition.

Why is domain/website scanning not included?

Scope discipline. Domain/website vulnerability scanning is a different job with a different engine — ours ships as the Website Vulnerability Scanner Community Edition (202 scanner modules, same license philosophy). The two repos cross-link each other.

Is this an AI tool?

No. Zero AI, zero ML, zero external "smart" services. Every check is a deterministic, reproducible HTTP lookup with honest three-state verdicts (exposed / clear / unavailable). If a source is down, the card says so instead of guessing. That is a feature.

Why do some cards say "unavailable"?

Honesty over theater. Public APIs rate-limit, change, or hiccup. A source that could not answer is shown as unavailable — it does NOT count as "clear", and it does not kill the rest of the check (per-source isolation). Re-run the check to retry.

Where does the data come from?

23 keyless public sources — breach databases (XposedOrNot, HIBP Pwned Passwords), infostealer corpus (HudsonRock), the COMB credential corpus (ProxyNova), disposable-email databases, the Maigret/WhatsMyName 150-site username corpus, Bluesky, Hacker News, GitHub public search, Shodan InternetDB, ipapi.is, DNS blocklists (Spamhaus ZEN, SpamCop, Barracuda) and more. Full table with attribution: SOURCES.md.

Can I turn sources off?

Yes — Settings page → per-source toggles. Disabled sources are never contacted.

Is it really self-hosted with no API keys?

Yes. Every source in the Community Edition is keyless. Clone, ./install.sh, sign in, check. The only optional outbound calls beyond the lookups happen when you explicitly activate, refresh or deactivate a free community key (see PRIVACY.md) — and the license code is short and auditable.

How is this different from holehe / mosint / sherlock?

Those are good tools (some now unmaintained) that each cover one slice — holehe: email→registered-website accounts; sherlock/maigret: username→platforms. Exposure-Check-OSINT covers email and username and phone and password and IP in one self-hosted dashboard with an honest exposure score, history, printable reports and per-source verdicts. It is a maintained, complete product rather than a CLI one-trick pass.

What license is this? Is there a trial or a feature wall?

Apache-2.0 (application code). There is no trial and no wall (v2, Oct 2026): every source, check, report and export works forever without a key. The optional free community key only powers the aggregate install counter and free premium update announcements, and carries zero telemetry by default. The username site corpus carries upstream attribution (maigret MIT, WhatsMyName CC BY-SA 4.0) — see storage/app/maigret/sites.json header. Full details in the LICENSE file and SOURCES.md.